

The Divine Liturgy

Note:

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Some changes are made in this liturgy for use in a prison setting.

It is begun thus:

Deacon: Bless, master. *(Said only if a deacon serves)*

Priest: Blessed is the Kingdom of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.¹

Choir: Amen.

If it be between Pascha and the leave-taking, before the Great Litany, the clergy chant 'Christ is risen' 2 1/2 times, and the choir finishes.

Christ is risen from the dead, trampling down death by death, // and on those in the tombs bestowing life!	Христос воскрес из мертвых, смертию смерть поправ, // и сущим во гробех живот даровав!	Χριστος Ανέστη εκ νεκρων, θανάτω θάνατον πατήσας, και τοις εν τοις μνημασι, // ζωην χαρισάμενος!
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Deacon or Priest: In peace² let us pray to the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--For the peace from above, and the salvation of our souls, let us pray to the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--For the peace of the whole world, the good estate of the holy churches of God, and the union of all, let us pray to the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--For this holy temple, and for them that with faith, reverence, and the fear of God enter herein, let us pray to the Lord

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--For our Great Lord and Father, His Holiness, Patriarch N.; for our lord the Very Most Reverend Metropolitan N., First Hierarch of the Russian

Church Abroad; for our lord the Most Reverend (Archbishop or Bishop N.); for the venerable priesthood, the deaconate in Christ, for all the clergy and people, let us pray to the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--For this land, its authorities and armed forces, let us pray to the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--For the God preserved Russian Land³ and its Orthodox people both in the homeland and in the diaspora, and for their salvation, let us pray to the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--That He may deliver His people from enemies both visible and invisible, and confirm in us oneness of mind, brotherly love and piety, let us pray to the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--For this city (or this town, or this holy monastery), for every city and country, and the faithful that dwell therein, let us pray to the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--For seasonable weather, abundance of the fruits of the earth, and peaceful times, let us pray to the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--For travelers by sea, land and air; for the sick, the suffering, the imprisoned, and for their salvation, let us pray to the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--That we may be delivered from all tribulation, wrath, and necessity, let us pray to the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--Help us, save us, have mercy on us, and keep us, O God, by Thy grace.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--Calling to remembrance our most holy, most pure, most blessed, glorious Lady Theotokos and Ever-Virgin Mary with all the saints, let us commit ourselves and one another and all our life unto Christ our God.

Choir: To Thee O Lord... (Slowly, if there be no deacon)

The Prayer of the First Antiphon (silently)

Priest: O Lord our God, Whose dominion is indescribable, and Whose glory is incomprehensible, Whose mercy is infinite, and Whose love for mankind is ineffable: Do thou thyself, O Master, according to Thy tender compassion, look upon us, and upon this holy temple, and deal with us, and them that pray with us, according to Thine abundant mercies and compassions.

Priest: For unto Thee is due all glory, honor and worship; to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.

Choir: Amen.

The First Antiphon may be sung in a

- *long form (the entire Psalm/),*
- *short form (excerpts of the Psalm),*
- *or, if a simple service during the week, as a “daily antiphon”.*

All three forms follow.

The First Antiphon

Bless the Lord, O my soul; blessed art Thou, O Lord. * Bless the Lord, O my soul, and all that is within me bless His holy name. * Bless the Lord, O my soul, and forget not all that He hath done for thee. * Who is gracious unto all thine iniquities, Who healeth all thine infirmities. * Who redeemeth thy life from corruption, Who crowneth thee with mercy and compassion. * Who fulfilleth thy desire with good things; thy youth shall be renewed as the eagle's. * The Lord performeth deeds of mercy, and executeth judgment for all them that are wronged. * He hath made His ways known unto Moses, unto the sons of Israel the things that He hath willed. * Compassionate and merciful is the Lord, long-suffering and plenteous in mercy. * Not unto the end will He be angered, neither unto eternity will He be wroth. * Not according to our iniquities hath He dealt with us, neither according to our sins hath He rewarded us. * For according to the height of heaven from the earth, the Lord hath made His mercy to prevail over them that fear Him. * As far as the east is from the west, so far hath He removed our iniquities from us. * Like as a father hath compassion upon his sons, so hath the Lord had compassion upon them that fear Him; * for He knoweth whereof we are made, He hath remembered that we are dust. * As for man, his days are as the grass; as a flower of the field, so shall he blossom forth. * For when the wind is passed over it, then it shall be gone, and no longer will it know the place thereof. * But the mercy of the Lord is from eternity, even unto eternity, upon them that fear Him. * And His righteousness is upon sons of sons, upon them that keep His testament and remember His commandments to do them. * The Lord in heaven hath prepared His

throne, and His kingdom ruleth over all. * Bless the Lord, all ye His angels, mighty in strength, that perform His word, to hear the voice of His words. * Bless the Lord, all ye His hosts, His ministers that do His will. * Bless the Lord, all ye His works, in every place of His dominion.

Glory to the Father, * and to the Son, * and to the Holy Spirit. * Both now and ever, * and unto the ages of ages. Amen.

Bless the Lord, O my soul, * and all that is within me * bless His holy name; * blessed art Thou, O Lord.

Abbreviated First Antiphon

Bless the Lord, O my Soul; * blessed art Thou, O Lord. * Bless the Lord, O my soul, * and all that is within me bless His holy name. * Bless the Lord, O my soul, * and forget not all that He hath done for these. * Who is gracious unto all thine iniquities, * Who healeth all thine infirmities. * Who redeemeth thy life from corruption, * Who crowneth thee with mercy and compassion. * Who fulfilleth thy desire with good things; * thy youth shall be renewed as the eagle's. * Compassionate and merciful is the Lord, * long-suffering and plenteous in mercy.

Glory to the Father, * and to the Son, * and to the Holy Spirit; * Both now and ever, * and unto the ages of ages. Amen.

Bless the Lord, O my soul, * and all that is within me * bless His holy name; blessed art Thou, O Lord.

When there is a simple service daily antiphons are sung instead of the usual ones (Bless the Lord and Praise the Lord):

The First Daily Antiphon, Ps 91:

Stichos 1: It is good to give praise unto the Lord / and to chant unto Thy name, O Most High.

Refrain: Through the prayers of the Theotokos, O Savior, save us.

Stichos 2: To proclaim in the morning Thy mercy / and Thy truth by night.

Refrain: Through the prayers of the Theotokos, O Savior, save us.

Stichos 3: That upright is the Lord our God, / and there is no unrighteousness in Him.

Refrain: Through the prayers of the Theotokos, O Savior, save us.

Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, / both now and ever and unto the ages of ages. Amen.

Refrain: Through the prayers of the Theotokos, O Savior, save us.

Small Ectenia:

Deacon or Priest: Again and again, in peace let us pray to the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--Help us, save us, have mercy on us, and keep us, O God, by Thy grace.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--Calling to remembrance our most holy, most pure, most blessed, glorious Lady Theotokos and Ever-Virgin Mary with all the saints, let us commit ourselves and one another and all our life unto Christ our God.

Choir: To Thee, O Lord.

The Prayer of the Second Antiphon (silently)

Priest: O Lord our God, save Thy people and bless Thine inheritance, preserve the fullness of thy Church, sanctify them that love the beauty of Thy house; do Thou glorify Them by Thy divine power, and forsake not us that hope in Thee.

Priest: For Thine is the dominion, and Thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory: of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.

Choir: Amen.

The Second Antiphon may be sung in a

- *long form (the entire Psalm/),*
- *or, if a simple service during the week, as a “daily antiphon”.*

All three forms follow.

The Second Antiphon

Glory to the Father, * and to the Son, * and to the Holy Spirit. *

Praise the Lord, O my soul. I will praise the Lord in my life, I will chant unto my God for as long as I have my being. * Trust ye not in princes, in the sons of men, in whom there is no salvation. * His spirit shall go forth, and he shall return unto his earth. In that day all his thoughts shall perish. * Blessed is he of whom the God of Jacob is his help, whose hope is in the Lord his God, * Who hath made heaven and the earth, the sea and all that is therein. * Who keepeth truth unto eternity, Who executeth judgment for the wronged, Who giveth food unto the hungry. * The Lord looseth the fettered; the Lord maketh wise the blind; the Lord setteth aright the fallen; * the Lord loveth the righteous; the Lord preserveth the proselytes. * He shall adopt for His own the orphan and widow, and the way of sinners shall He destroy. * The Lord shall be king unto eternity; thy God, O Zion, unto generation and generation.

Both now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. Amen.

Only-Begotten Son and Word of God, Thou Who art immortal, and didst deign for our salvation to become incarnate of the holy Theotokos and Ever-virgin Mary, without change becoming man, and Who wast crucified, O Christ God, trampling down death by death: Thou Who art one of the Holy Trinity, glorified together with the Father and the Holy Spirit, save us.

When there is a simple service daily antiphons are sung instead of the usual ones (Bless the Lord and Praise the Lord):

The Second Daily Antiphon, Ps 92:

Stichos 1: The Lord is King, He is clothed with majesty; / the Lord is clothed with strength and He hath girt Himself.

Refrain: Through the prayers of Thy saints, O Savior, save us.

Stichos 2: For He established the world / which shall not be shaken.

Refrain: Through the prayers of Thy saints, O Savior, save us.

Stichos 3: Thy testimonies are made very sure. / Holiness becometh Thy house, O Lord, unto length of days.

Refrain: Through the prayers of Thy saints, O Savior, save us.

Glory to the Father, * and to the Son, * and to the Holy Spirit, Both now and ever, * and unto the ages of ages. Amen.

Only-Begotten Son and Word of God, Thou Who art immortal, and didst deign for our salvation to become incarnate of the holy Theotokos and Ever-virgin Mary, without change becoming man, and Who wast crucified, O Christ God, trampling down death by death: Thou Who art one of the Holy Trinity, glorified together with the Father and the Holy Spirit, save us.

Small Ectenia:

Deacon or Priest: Again and again, in peace let us pray to the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--Help us, save us, have mercy on us, and keep us, O God, by Thy grace.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--Calling to remembrance our most holy, most pure, most blessed, glorious Lady Theotokos and Ever-Virgin Mary with all the saints, let us commit ourselves and one another and all our life unto Christ our God.

Choir: To Thee, O Lord.

The Prayer of the Third Antiphon (silently)

Priest: O Thou who hast bestowed upon us these common and concordant prayers, and Who hast promised that when two or three are agreed in Thy name, Thou wouldst grant their requests: Do Thou Thyself now fulfill the requests of Thy servants to their profit, granting us in this present age the knowledge of Thy truth, and in that to come, life everlasting.

Priest: For a good God art Thou, and the Lover of mankind, and unto Thee do we send up glory: to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.

Choir: Amen.

The Third antiphon may be sung in two forms:

- *the beatitudes (with or without Stichera verses inserted near the end)*
- *or, if a simple service during the week, as a “daily antiphon”.*

Both forms follow.

Third Antiphon

In Thy kingdom remember us,
O Lord, * when Thou comest
in Thy kingdom.

12. Blessed are the poor in
spirit, * for theirs is the
kingdom of heaven.

[In 12 verses]

11. Blessed are they that
mourn, * for they shall be
comforted.

10. Blessed are the meek, *
for they shall inherit the earth.

[In 10 verses]

9. Blessed are they that
hunger and thirst after
righteousness, * for they shall
be filled.

8. Blessed are the merciful, *
for they shall obtain mercy.

[In 8 verses]

7. Blessed are the pure in
heart, * for they shall see
God.

3. Rejoice, and be exceeding
glad, * for great is your reward
in the heavens.

6. Blessed are the
peacemakers, * for they shall
be called the sons of God.

2. Glory to the Father, * and to
the Son, * and to the Holy
Spirit.

5. Blessed are they which are
persecuted for righteousness'
sake, * for theirs is the
kingdom of heaven.

1. Both now and ever, * and
unto the ages of ages. Amen.

4. Blessed are ye, when men
shall revile you, and
persecute you, * and shall say
all manner of evil against you
falsely, for my sake.

The Third Daily Antiphon, Ps 94:

Stichos 1: Come let us rejoice in the Lord, / let us shout with jubilation unto God our Savior.

Refrain: O Son of God Who art wondrous in the saints, / save us who chant unto Thee: Alleluia.

Stichos 2: Let us come before His countenance with thanksgiving, / and with psalms let us shout in jubilation unto Him.

Refrain: O Son of God Who art wondrous in the saints, / save us who chant unto Thee: Alleluia.

Stichos 3: For the Lord is a great God / and a great King over all the earth.

Refrain: O Son of God Who art wondrous in the saints, / save us who chant unto Thee: Alleluia.

Stichos 4: For in His hand are the ends of the earth, / and the heights of the mountains are His.

Refrain: O Son of God Who art wondrous in the saints, / save us who chant unto Thee: Alleluia.

Stichos 5: For the sea is His and He made it; / and the dry land His hands have fashioned.

Refrain: O Son of God Who art wondrous in the saints, / save us who chant unto Thee: Alleluia.

Glory to the Father, * and to the Son, * and to the Holy Spirit, Both now and ever, * and unto the ages of ages. Amen.

Refrain: O Son of God Who art wondrous in the saints, / save us who chant unto Thee: Alleluia.

The Small Entry

Here the doors are opened for the Small Entry. Then the Third Antiphon is chanted by the singers; or the beatitudes, if it be Sunday. When they come to the Glory, the priest and the deacon, standing before the Holy Table, make three reverences. The priest, taking the Holy Gospel, giveth it to the deacon, and they go by way of the right side, behind the Holy Table. And thus coming out by the North side, with candles going before them, they make the Small Entry; and standing in the usual place, both of them bow their heads, and the deacon having said: 'Let us pray to the Lord', the priest saith the Prayer of Entry secretly.

Prayer of the Entry (silently)

Priest: O Master, Lord our God, who hast appointed in the heavens ranks and hosts of angels and archangels unto the service of Thy glory: With our entry do Thou cause the entry of the holy angels, serving and glorifying Thy goodness with us. For unto Thee is due all glory, honor, and worship: to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever and unto the ages of ages. Amen.

When the prayer is ended, the deacon says to the priest, pointing toward the east with his right hand, holding therein his orarion with three fingers:

Deacon only: Bless, master, the holy entrance.

And the priest, blessing, saith:

Priest: Blessed is the entry of Thy holy ones always, now and ever and unto the ages of ages.

Deacon: Amen.

Deacon or Priest: Wisdom! Aright!

If it is a great feast of the Lord, the priest sings the appointed Entry Verse, or "Introit".

And the clergy enter the altar through the Royal Doors, and the singers chant:

Choir: O come, let us worship and fall down before Christ. O Son of God ...

If it be a weekday:

... Who art wondrous in the saints, save us who chant unto Thee: Alleluia.

If it be a Sunday:

... Who art risen from the dead, save us who chant unto Thee: Alleluia.

On feasts of the Theotokos:

... Through the prayers of the Theotokos, save us who chant unto Thee: Alleluia.

Troparia & Kontakia

The appointed Troparia and Kontakia of the day are now sung.

This part of the liturgy changes every day. In prison, we may sing troparia appointed for the day according to the church calendar. We also will usually sing the Resurrectional Troparion and Kontakion sung the previous Sunday, and Kontakion to the patron of the Texas Prison Ministry – Joseph the All-Comely.

Troparia of the Resurrection

First Tone.

When the stone had been sealed by the Jews, and the soldiers were guarding Thine immaculate Body, Thou didst rise on the third day, O Savior, granting life unto the world. Wherefore, the Hosts of the Heavens cried out to Thee, O Life-giver: Glory to Thy Resurrection, O Christ. Glory to Thy kingdom. Glory to Thy dispensation, O only Lover of mankind.

Second Tone.

When Thou didst descend unto death, O Life Immortal, then didst Thou slay Hades with the lightning of Thy Divinity. And when Thou didst also raise the dead out of the nethermost depths, all the Hosts of Heavens cried out: O Lifegiver, Christ our God, glory be to Thee.

Third Tone

Let the heavens be glad; let earthly things rejoice; for the Lord hath wrought might with His arm. He hath trampled down death by death; the first-born of the dead hath He become. From the belly of Hades hath He delivered us and hath granted to the world great mercy.

Fourth Tone.

Having learned the joyful proclamation of the Resurrection from the angel, and having cast off the ancestral condemnation, the women disciples of the Lord spake to the apostles exultantly: Death is despoiled and Christ God is risen, granting to the world great mercy.

Fifth Tone.

Let us, O faithful, praise and worship the Word Who is co-unoriginate with the Father and the Spirit, and Who was born of the Virgin for our salvation; for He was pleased to ascend the Cross in the flesh and to endure death, and to raise the dead by His glorious Resurrection

Sixth Tone.

Angelic Hosts were above Thy tomb, and they that guarded Thee became as dead. And Mary stood by the grave seeking Thine immaculate Body. Thou didst despoil Hades and wast not tempted by it. Thou didst meet the Virgin and didst grant us life. O Thou Who didst rise from the dead, O Lord, glory be to Thee.

Seventh Tone.

Thou didst destroy death by Thy Cross, Thou didst open Paradise to the thief. Thou didst change the lamentation of the Myrrh-bearers, and Thou didst command Thine Apostles to proclaim that Thou didst arise, O Christ God, and grantest to the world great mercy.

Eighth Tone.

From on high didst Thou descend, O Compassionate One; to burial of three days hast Thou submitted that Thou mightest free us from our passions. O our Life and Resurrection, O Lord, glory be to Thee.

Monday- The Bodiless Hosts Troparion, Fourth Tone:

Supreme Commanders of the heavenly hosts, we unworthy ones implore you that by your supplications ye will encircle us with the shelter of the wings of your immaterial glory, and guard us who fall down before you and fervently cry: Deliver us from dangers since ye are the marshals of the hosts on high

Tuesday- St. John the Forerunner Troparion, Second Tone:

The memory of the righteous is celebrated with hymns of praise, but the Lords testimony is sufficient for thee, O Forerunner; for thou has proved to be even more venerable than the prophets, since thou wast granted to baptize in the running waters Him Whom they proclaimed. wherefore, having contested for the truth, thou didst rejoice to announce the good tidings even to those in Hades: that God hath appeared in the flesh, taking away the sin of the world and granting us great mercy.

Wednesday and Friday- The Cross. Troparion, First Tone:

Save, O Lord, thy people, and bless Thine inheritance; grant Thou unto Orthodox Christians victory over enemies; and by the power of the Cross do Thou preserve Thy commonwealth.

Thursday- The Holy Apostles and St. Nicholas Troparion, Third Tone

O Apostles, Martyrs, and Prophets, Hierarchs, Monastics, and Righteous Ones; ye that have accomplished a good labour and kept the Faith, that have boldness before the Savior; O Good Ones, intercede for us, we pray, that our souls be saved.

Then:

Troparia from the Menaion if any.

Kontakia of the Resurrection

First Tone.

As God Thou didst arise from the tomb in glory, and Thou didst raise the world together with Thyself. And mortal nature praiseth Thee as God, and death hath vanished. And Adam danceth, O Master, and Eve, now freed from fetters, rejoiceth as she crieth out: Thou art He, O Christ, that grantest unto all resurrection.

Second Tone

Thou didst arise from the tomb, O omnipotent Savior, and Hades was terrified on beholding the wonder; and the dead arose, and creation at the sight thereof rejoiceth with Thee. And Adam also is joyful, and world, O my Savior, praiseth Thee for ever.

Third Tone.

Thou didst rise today from the tomb, O Merciful One, and didst lead us out of the gates of death. Today Adam danceth and Eve rejoiceth; and together with them both the Prophets and Patriarchs unceasingly praise the divine might of Thine authority.

Fourth Tone.

My Savior and Redeemer hath, as God, raised up the earthborn from the grave and from their fetters, and He hath broken the gates of Hades, and, Master, hath risen on the third day.

Fifth Tone.

Unto Hades, O my Savior, didst Thou descend, and having broken its gates as One omnipotent, Thou, as Creator, didst raise up the dead together with Thyself. And Thou didst break the sting of death, and didst deliver Adam from the curse, O Lover of mankind. Wherefore, we all cry unto Thee: Save us, O Lord.

Sixth Tone.

Having by His life-bestowing hand raised up all the dead out of the dark abysses, Christ God, the Giver of Life, hath bestowed the Resurrection upon the fallen human race; for He is the Savior of all, the Resurrection, and the Life, and the God of all.

Seventh Tone.

No longer will the dominion of death be able to keep men captive; for Christ hath descended, demolishing and destroying the powers thereof. Hades is bound; the Prophets rejoice with one voice, saying: A Savior hath come for them that have faith. Come forth, ye faithful, for the Resurrection.

Eighth Tone.

Having arisen from the tomb, Thou didst raise up the dead and didst resurrect Adam. Eve also danceth at Thy Resurrection, and the ends of the world celebrate Thine arising from the dead, O Greatly-merciful One.

Monday- The Bodiless Hosts Kontakion, Second Tone:

Supreme Commanders of God and the ministers of the Divine Glory, guides of men and leaders of the angels, ask for what is to our profit and for great mercy, since ye are the Supreme Commanders of the Bodiless Hosts.

Tuesday- St. John the Forerunner. Kontakion, Second Tone:

O Prophet of god, and Forerunner of grace, having obtained thy head from the earth as a most sacred rose, we ever receive healings; for again, as of old in the world, thou preachest repentance.

Wednesday and Friday- The Cross. Kontakion, Fourth Tone:

O Thou Who wast lifted up willingly on the Cross, bestow Thy mercies upon the new community named after Thee, O Christ God; Gladden with Thy power the Orthodox Christians, granting them victory over enemies; may they have as Thy help the weapon of peace, the invincible trophy.

Patriarch Joseph the All-Comely Kontakion 8th Tone

Jacob lamented the loss of Joseph, / but his righteous son was seated in a chariot and honored as a king. / For he was not enslaved to the pleasures of Egypt, / but he was glorified by God who sees the hearts of men // and bestows on them a crown incorruptible.

Kontakia from the Menaion, if any

Then:

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit

Kontakion for the Departed, 8th tone, special melody:

With the saints give rest, / O Christ, / to the souls of Thy servants, / where there is
neither sickness, nor sorrow, / nor sighing, // but life everlasting.

Both now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.

O protection of Christians

O protection of Christians that cannot be put to shame, O Mediation unto the Creator
unfailing:

Disdain not the suppliant voices of sinners;

but be thou quick, O good one, to help us who in faith cry unto Thee;

hasten to intercession and speed thou to make supplication,

thou who dost ever protect, O Theotokos, them that honor thee.

After all the troparia and Kontakia are chanted, the priest and deacon, if he is serving will make their exclamations;

If a Deacon serve:

If a Deacon, but not a bishop serve, after the Kontakion is ended, the deacon cometh out through the holy doors, and standing on the ambo and pointing with his orarion, first to the icon of Christ, saith:

Priest: For holy art Thou, O our God, and unto Thee do we send up glory: to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever:

Deacon Only: O Lord, save the pious, and hearken unto us.

People: O Lord, save the pious and hearken unto us.

Then he pointeth to all the people, saying in a loud voice:

Deacon Only: And unto the ages of ages.

People: Amen.

But if it be a hierachal liturgy, and a Deacon serve, after the Kontakion is ended, the deacon cometh out through the holy doors, and standing on the ambo and pointing with his orarion, first to the icon of Christ, saith:

Deacon Only: O Lord, save the pious!

People: O Lord, save the pious!

Deacon Only: And hearken unto us.

People: And hearken unto us.

Then he pointeth to all the people, saying in a loud voice:

Deacon Only: And unto the ages of ages.

People: Amen.

If the priest is serving alone:

If there is no deacon, "O Lord, save the pious..." is omitted.

Priest: For holy art Thou, O our God, and unto Thee do we send up glory: to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever and unto the ages of ages!

Choir: Amen.

The Trisagion

Trisagion*

**When "as many as have been baptized..." or "Before Thy Cross..." are appointed, they are sung in place of the Trisagion.*

This is sung slowly, and melodically, to allow the priest time to say his prayer

Holy God, Holy mighty, Holy Immortal have mercy on us.

Holy God, Holy mighty, Holy Immortal have mercy on us.

Holy God, Holy mighty, Holy Immortal have mercy on us.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, both now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. Amen. Holy Immortal have mercy on us.

Holy God, Holy mighty, Holy Immortal have mercy on us.

While the Trisagion is chanted, the priest saith this prayer:

The Prayer of the Trisagion Hymn

Priest: O Holy God, Who retest in the saints, Who art praised with the thrice-holy hymn by the Seraphim, and art glorified by the Cherubim, and art worshiped by all the heavenly hosts, Who from nonbeing hast brought all things into being, Who hast created man according to Thine image and likeness, and hast adorned him with Thine every gift; Who givest wisdom and understanding to him that asketh, and Who disdainest not him that sinneth, but hast appointed repentance unto salvation; Who hast vouchsafed us, Thy lowly and unworthy servants, to stand even in this hour before the glory of Thy holy altar, and to offer the worship and glory due unto Thee: Do Thou Thyself, O Master, accept even from the lips of us sinners the thrice-holy hymn, and visit us in Thy goodness.

Pardon us every sin, voluntary and involuntary; sanctify our souls and bodies, and grant us to serve Thee in holiness all the days of our life, through the intercessions of the holy Theotokos, and of all the saints, who from ages past have been pleasing unto Thee. For holy art Thou, O our God, and unto Thee do we send up glory: to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.

When the prayer is ended, both the priest and deacon themselves say the Trisagion Hymn, making together three bows before the Holy Table. Then the deacon saith to the Priest:

Deacon only: Command, O Master.

And they proceed to the high place; and the priest, as he goeth, saith:

Priest: Blessed is he that cometh in the name of the Lord.

Deacon only: *Bless, Master, the High Throne.*

And the priest, blessing, sayeth:

Priest: Blessed art Thou on the Throne of the glory of Thy Kingdom,
Thou that sittest on the Cherubim: always, now and ever, and unto
the ages of ages.

Deacon: Amen.

It is to be noted that it is not proper for the priest to go up onto the high place, nor to sit thereon, but to sit on the South side of the high throne.

And upon the conclusion of the Trisagion, the deacon, having come toward the holy doors, saith:

The Epistle

Deacon or Priest: Let us attend.

Priest or Bishop: Peace be unto all.

Reader: And to thy spirit.

Deacon or Priest: Wisdom!

Reader: The Prokimenon in the ____ Tone: *(And he gives the words of the Prokimenon. The Choir chant it.)*

Reader: Stichos. *The Choir repeat the Prokimenon.*

Reader: In the ____ Tone: *(And he gives the second prokimenon.) (Or, if there be only one prokimenon, he may give a second stichos; otherwise he will give the first half of the prokimenon, and Choir chant the second half.)*

Deacon or Priest: Wisdom!

Reader: The Reading from:-(the Acts of the Holy Apostles, or: the catholic Epistle of N., or: The Epistle of the holy Apostle Paul to the N.)

Deacon or Priest: Let us attend.

Reader: *If it be from the Acts:* In those days..., *If it be from the Epistles of St. John:* Beloved..., *If it be from the Epistles of St. Paul:* Brethren..., *or:* My son Timothy...

And when the Epistle is concluded:

Priest or Bishop: Peace be unto thee.

Reader: Alleluia in the ____ Tone. *(If there be two prokimena, he may also give a stichos before the Choir chant the first time.)*

Choir: Alleluia, alleluia, alleluia.

Reader: Stichos. *Choir chant second time in same tone.*

Reader: In the ____ Tone: *Stichos. Choir chant final time.*

The Gospel

The Prayer before the Gospel (silently)

Priest: Shine forth within our hearts the incorruptible light of Thy knowledge, O Master, Lover of mankind, and open the eyes of our mind to the understanding of the preaching of Thy Gospel; instill in us also the fear of Thy blessed commandments, that, trampling down all lusts of the flesh, we may pursue a spiritual way of life, being mindful of and doing all that is well-pleasing unto Thee. For Thou art the enlightenment of our souls and bodies, O Christ God, and unto Thee do we send up glory, together with Thine unoriginate Father, and Thy most holy and good and life-creating Spirit, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. Amen.

Priest: Wisdom! Aright! Let us hear the Holy Gospel.

Priest: Peace be unto all.

Choir: And to thy spirit.

Priest: The Reading is from the Holy Gospel according to N.

Choir: Glory to Thee, O Lord, glory to thee.

Priest: Let us attend.

Then the Gospel is read...

Choir: Glory to Thee, O Lord, glory to Thee.

The Litany of Fervent Supplication

Deacon or Priest: Let us all say with our whole soul and with our whole mind, let us say.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--O Lord Almighty, the God of our fathers, we pray Thee, hearken and have mercy.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--Have mercy on us, O God, according to Thy great mercy, we pray Thee, hearken and have mercy.

Choir: Lord, have mercy. *Thrice.*

--Again we pray for our Great Lord and Father, His Holiness, Patriarch N.; for our lord the Very Most Reverend Metropolitan N., First Hierarch of the Russian Church Abroad; for our lord the Most Reverend (Archbishop or Bishop N., whose diocese it is) and all our brethren in Christ.

Choir: Lord, have mercy. *Thrice. Slowly, if there is no Deacon*

--Again we pray for this land, its authorities and armed forces.

Choir: Lord, have mercy. *Thrice.*

--Again we pray for the God preserved Russian Land and its Orthodox people both in the homeland and in the diaspora and for their salvation.

Choir: Lord, have mercy. *Thrice.*

--Again we pray to the Lord our God that He may deliver His people from enemies visible and invisible, and confirm in us oneness of mind, brotherly love and piety.

Choir: Lord, have mercy. *Thrice.*

At his place, we insert prayers for the persecuted, according to local custom

Petitions for the persecuted because of their faith in Christ, and our brethren that are suffering because of war.

--Again we pray for our suffering brethren and those who in the name of Christ are persecuted, harassed, tortured & murdered in

[Syria, Egypt, Iran, Iraq, Pakistan, Nigeria, Sudan & throughout the world,]

& for the salvation and preservation of their lives & their holy places

& especially for St Catherine's Monastery, Metropolitan Paul & Archbishop John & the priest Joseph & his flock

Choir: Lord, have mercy. *Thrice*

--Again we pray to the Lord our God for All those who suffer from acts of war, especially for the victims and all those involved in the struggle in

[Syria, Iraq, Gaza, Ukraine & throughout the world]

& for His peace & mercy in the midst of the great suffering that people are now inflicting on each other, & that He would accept the prayers of His Church, so that by His goodness peace may return to all peoples

Choir: Lord, have mercy. *Thrice*

--Again we pray that the Lord our God will grant repentance, & enlighten the minds & hearts of those who commit injustice against their neighbors, whether by causing sorrow to orphans or spilling innocent blood or by returning hatred for hatred, & illumine their souls with the light of love even towards their enemies

Choir: Lord, have mercy. *Thrice*

The regular petitions resume here.

--Again we pray for our brethren, the priests, priestmonks, and all our brethren in Christ.

Choir: Lord have mercy. *Thrice.*

--Again we pray for the blessed and ever-memorable, holy Orthodox patriarchs; for pious kings and right-believing queens; and for the founders of this holy temple (if it be a monastery: this holy monastery): and for all our fathers and brethren gone to their rest before us, and the Orthodox here and everywhere laid to rest.

Choir: Lord, have mercy. *Thrice.*

Here may be inserted various additional petitions, i.e., for the ill and afflicted, the newly-baptized, etc.

--Again we pray for them that bring offerings and do good works in this holy and all-venerable temple; for them that minister and them that chant, and for all the people here present, that await of Thee great and abundant mercy.

Choir: Lord, have mercy. *Thrice.*

The Prayer of Feverent Supplication (silently)

Priest: O Lord our God, accept this fervent supplication from Thy servants, and have mercy upon us according to the multitude of thy mercies; and send down Thy compassions upon us and upon all Thy people, that await of Thee abundant mercy.

Priest: For a merciful God Art Thou, and the Lover of mankind, and unto Thee do we send up glory: to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.

Choir: Amen.

The Litany of the Catechumens

Deacon or Priest: Pray, ye catechumens, to the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--Ye faithful, for the catechumens let us pray, that the Lord will have mercy on them.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--That He will catechize them with the word of Truth.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--That He will reveal unto them the Gospel of righteousness.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--That He will unite them to His Holy, Catholic, and Apostolic Church.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--Save them, have mercy on them, help them, and keep them, O God, by Thy grace.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--Ye catechumens, bow your heads unto the Lord.

Choir: To Thee, O Lord. (Slowly, if there be no deacon.)

The Prayer for the Catechumens before the Holy Anaphora (silently)

Priest: O Lord our God, who dwellest on high and lookest down on things that are lowly, Who unto the human race hast sent forth salvation, Thine Only-Begotten Son and God our Lord Jesus Christ: Look upon Thy servants the catechumens, who have bowed their necks before Thee, and vouchsafe unto them at a seasonable time the laver of regeneration, the remission of sins, and the garment of incorruption; unite them to Thy Holy, Catholic and Apostolic Church, and number them among Thy chosen flock.

Priest: That they also with us may glorify Thy most honorable and majestic name: of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.

Choir: Amen.

The Litany of the Faithful

Deacon or Priest: As many as are catechumens, depart; catechumens, depart; as many as are catechumens, depart; let none of the catechumens remain; as many as are of the faithful, again and again, in peace let us pray to the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy. (*Slowly if there be no deacon.*)

--Help us, save us, have mercy on us, and keep us, O God, by Thy grace.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--Wisdom!

The First Prayer of the Faithful (silently)

Priest: We thank Thee, O Lord God of Hosts, who hast vouchsafed us to stand even now before Thy Holy Altar, and to fall down before Thy compassion for our sins, and for the errors of the people. Receive, O God, our supplication; make us to be worthy to offer unto Thee supplications and entreaties and bloodless sacrifices for all Thy people. And enable us whom Thou hast placed in this Thy ministry, by the power of Thy Holy Spirit, without condemnation or faltering, with the clear witness of our conscience, to call upon Thee at all times and in every place, that, hearkening unto us, Thou mayest be gracious unto us in the multitude of Thy goodness.

Priest: For unto Thee is due all glory, honor and worship: to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.

Choir: Amen.

The Second Litany of the Faithful

--Again and again, in peace let us pray to the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy. (Slowly, if there be no deacon.)

If there be no deacon, the following petitions are not said:

--For the peace from above, and the salvation of our souls, let us pray to the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--For the peace of the whole world, the good estate of the holy churches of God, and the union of all, let us pray to the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--For this holy temple, and for them that with faith, reverence, and the fear of God enter herein, let us pray to the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--That we may be delivered from all tribulation, wrath, and necessity, let us pray to the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

These petitions are always said:

--Help us, save us, have mercy on us, and keep us, O God, by Thy grace.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--Wisdom!

The Second Prayer of the Faithful (silently)

Priest: Again and often times we fall down before Thee, O Good One and Lover of mankind, that, regarding our supplication, Thou wilt cleanse our souls and bodies of all defilement of flesh and spirit, and grant us to stand guiltless and uncondemned before Thy holy altar. Grant also, O God, to them that pray with us, advancement in life and faith and spiritual understanding. Grant them ever to serve Thee with fear and love, and to partake, guiltless and uncondemned, of thy Holy Mysteries, and to be vouchsafed Thy heavenly kingdom.

Priest: That always being guarded under Thy dominion, we may send up glory unto Thee: to the Father, and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.

Choir: Amen.

The Cherubic Hymn

Choir: Let us who mystically represent the Cherubim, and chant the thrice-holy hymn unto the Life-creating Trinity, now lay aside all earthly care.

Repeat, slowly, as needed.

The prayer which the priest reciteth secretly, while the Cherubic hymn is being chanted:

Prayer of the Cherubic Hymn (silently)

Priest: None is worthy among them that are bound with carnal lusts and pleasures, to approach or to draw nigh, or to minister unto Thee, O King of glory, for to serve Thee is a great and fearful thing even unto the heavenly hosts themselves. Yet because of Thine ineffable and immeasurable love for mankind, without change or alteration Thou didst become man, and didst become our High Priest, and didst deliver unto us the ministry of this liturgical and bloodless sacrifice, for Thou art the Master of all. Thou alone, O Lord our God, dost rule over those in heaven and those on earth, art borne upon the throne of the Cherubim, art Lord of the Seraphim and King of Israel, Thou alone art holy and retest in the saints.

I implore Thee, therefore, Who alone art good and inclined to listen: Look upon me Thy sinful and unprofitable servant, and purge my soul and heart of a wicked conscience, and, by the power of thy Holy Spirit, enable me, who am clothed with the grace of the priesthood, to stand before this Thy Holy Table, and to perform the sacred Mystery of Thy holy and immaculate Body and precious Blood. For unto Thee do I draw nigh, bowing my neck, and I pray

Thee: Turn not Thy countenance away from me, neither cast me out from among Thy children, but vouchsafe that these gifts be offered unto Thee by me, Thy sinful and unworthy servant: for Thou art He that offereth and is offered, that accepteth and is distributed, O Christ our God, and unto Thee do we send up glory, together with Thine unoriginate Father, and Thy most holy and good and life-creating Spirit, now and ever and unto the ages of ages.

The Great Entry

Deacon: Our Great Lord and Father, His Holiness N., Patriarch of Moscow and All Russia; our lord the Very Most Reverend N., Metropolitan of Eastern America and New York, and First Hierarch of the Russian Church abroad; our lord the Most Reverend N., Archbishop (or Bishop) of _____, may the Lord God remember in His kingdom always, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.

Priest: This American land, its authorities and the faithful that dwell therein, the God-preserved Russian land and its Orthodox people both in the homeland and in the diaspora, may the Lord God remember in His kingdom always, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.

The clergy, the monastics, all that are persecuted and suffer for the Orthodox Faith; the founders, benefactors and the brotherhood of this holy temple (or holy monastery), and all of you Orthodox Christians, may the Lord God remember in His kingdom always, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.

And the priest passeth through the holy doors. And the people say:

People: May the Lord God remember thy priesthood in His Kingdom, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. Amen.

Choir: Amen. That we may receive the King of all, Who cometh invisibly upborne in triumph by the ranks of angels. Alleluia, alleluia, alleluia.

As the priest passeth through the holy doors the deacon says to him:

Deacon: May the Lord God remember thy priesthood in His kingdom.

Priest: May the Lord God remember thy sacred diaconate in His kingdom, always, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.

And the priest then placeth the holy chalice on the Holy Table and taking the holy diskos from the head of the deacon, and placeth it on the Holy Table saying:

Priest: The noble Joseph, having taken Thy most pure Body down from the Tree and wrapped it in pure linen and covered It with spices, laid It in a new tomb.

In the grave bodily, but in Hades with Thy soul as God; in Paradise with the thief, and on the throne with the Father and the Spirit wast Thou Who fillest all things, O Christ the Inexpressible. How life-giving, how much more beautiful than Paradise and truly more resplendent than any royal palace hath Thy tomb appeared, O Christ, the source of our resurrection.

Then taking the veils from the holy diskos and the holy chalice, he layeth them to one side of the altar (in current practice, each is unfolded, and placed on the right and left side of the holy table, over the red cloth and under the cross on each side.) And taking the aer from the deacon's shoulder, and having censed it, he covereth the Holy Gifts therewith, saying:

Priest: The noble Joseph, having taken Thy most pure Body down

from the Tree and wrapped It in pure linen and covered It with spices, laid It in a new tomb.

And taking the censer from the hand of the deacon, he censeth the Holy Gifts thrice, saying:

Priest: Do good, O Lord, in Thy good pleasure unto Sion, and let the walls of Jerusalem be builded. Then shalt Thou be pleased with a sacrifice of righteousness, with oblation and whole-burnt offerings. Then shall they offer bullocks upon Thine altar.

The holy doors and curtain are closed.

The Litany of Supplication

Deacon or Priest: Let us complete our prayer unto the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--For the precious gifts set forth, let us pray to the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--For this holy temple, and for them that with faith, reverence, and the fear of God enter herein, let us pray to the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--That we may be delivered from all tribulation, wrath, and necessity, let us pray to the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy. (Slowly, if there be no deacon.)

--Help us, save us, have mercy on us, and keep us, O God, by Thy grace.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--That the whole day may be perfect, holy, peaceful and sinless, let us ask of the Lord.

Choir: Grant this, O Lord.

--An angel of peace, a faithful guide, a guardian of our souls and bodies, let us ask of the Lord.

Choir: Grant this, O Lord.

--Pardon and remission of our sins and offences, let us ask of the Lord.

Choir: Grant this, O Lord.

--Things good and profitable for our souls, and peace for the world, let us ask of the Lord.

Choir: Grant this, O Lord.

--That we may complete the remaining time of our life in peace and repentance, let us ask of the Lord.

Choir: Grant this, O Lord.

--A Christian ending to our life, painless, blameless, peaceful, and a good defense before the dread judgment seat of Christ, let us ask.

Choir: Grant this, O Lord.

--Calling to remembrance our most holy, most pure, most blessed, glorious Lady Theotokos and Ever-Virgin Mary with all the saints, let us commit ourselves and one another and all our life unto Christ our God.

Choir: To Thee, O Lord.

The deacon moves to stand before the icon of Christ while priest finisheth the prayer of Proskomedia.

The Prayer of the Proskomedia (silently)

Priest: O Lord God Almighty, who alone art holy, Who dost accept a sacrifice of praise from them that call upon Thee with their whole heart: Accept also the supplication of us sinners, and bring it to Thy Holy Altar, and enable us to offer unto Thee both gifts and spiritual sacrifices for our sins and for the errors of the people, and vouchsafe us to find grace before Thee, that our sacrifice may be acceptable unto Thee, and that the good Spirit of Thy grace may rest upon us, and upon these Gifts set forth, and upon all Thy people.

Priest: Through the compassions of Thine Only-begotten Son, with Whom Thou art blessed, together with Thy most holy, and good, and life-creating Spirit, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.

Choir: Amen.

Priest: Peace be unto all.

Choir: And to thy spirit.

Priest or Bishop: Let us love one another, that with one mind we may confess:

Choir: The Father, and the Son, and the Holy Spirit: The Trinity, one in essence and indivisible.

--The doors! The doors! In wisdom let us attend.

The Creed

I believe in one God, the Father Almighty, / Maker of heaven and earth and of all things visible and invisible. / And in one Lord Jesus Christ, the Son of God, / the Only-begotten, begotten of the Father before all ages; / Light of Light, true God of true God; / begotten, not made; of one essence with the Father, by Whom all things were made; / Who for us men and for our salvation came down from the heavens, / and was incarnate of the Holy Spirit and the Virgin Mary, and became man; / And was crucified for us under Pontius Pilate, / and suffered and was buried; / And arose again on the third day according to the Scriptures; / And ascended into the heavens, and sitteth at the right hand of the Father; / And shall come again, with glory, to judge both the living and the dead; / Whose kingdom shall have no end. / And in the Holy Spirit, the Lord, the Giver of life; Who proceedeth from the Father; / Who with the Father and the Son together is worshipped and glorified; Who spake by the prophets. / In One, Holy, Catholic, and Apostolic Church. / I confess one baptism for the remission of sins. / I look for the resurrection of the dead, / and the life of the age to come. Amen.

The Anaphora

Deacon or Priest: Let us stand well, let us stand with fear, let us attend, that we may offer the holy oblation in peace.

Choir: A mercy of peace, a sacrifice of praise.

Priest or Bishop: The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, and the love of God the Father, and the communion of the Holy Spirit be with you all.

Choir: And with thy spirit.

--Let us lift up our hearts.

Choir: We lift them up unto the Lord.

--Let us give thanks unto the Lord.

Choir: It is meet and right to worship the Father, and the Son, and the Holy Spirit: the Trinity, one in essence and indivisible.

The First Prayer of the Anaphora (silently)

Priest: It is meet and right to hymn Thee, to bless Thee, to praise Thee, to give thanks unto Thee, to worship Thee in every place of thy dominion, for Thou art God inexpressible, incomprehensible, invisible, unattainable, ever-existing, eternally the same, Thou and Thine Only-begotten Son and Thy Holy Spirit. Thou didst call us from nonbeing into being, and when we had fallen away, Thou didst raise us up again, and didst not cease to do all things until Thou hadst brought us up to heaven, and hadst bestowed upon us Thy kingdom which is to come. For all these things we give thanks unto Thee, to Thine Only-begotten Son, and to Thy Holy Spirit, for all things whereof we know, and whereof we know not; for the benefits both manifest and

hidden which have come upon us. We give thanks unto Thee also for this service which Thou hast been pleased to accept from our hands, though there stand before Thee thousands of archangels and ten thousands of angels, the cherubim and seraphim, six-winged, many-eyed, borne aloft on their wings.

And here the deacon taketh the holy star from the holy diskos, maketh the sign of the cross above it, and kissing it, layeth it aside as the priest saith:

Priest: Singing the triumphal hymn, shouting, crying aloud and saying:

Choir: Holy, Holy, Holy, Lord of Sabaoth; heaven and earth are full of Thy glory. Hosanna in the highest! Blessed is He that cometh in the name of the Lord. Hosanna in the highest!

The Second Prayer of the Anaphora

Priest: With these blessed hosts, O Master, Lover of mankind, we also cry aloud and say: Holy art Thou and most holy, Thou, and Thine only-begotten Son, and Thy Holy Spirit: holy art Thou and most holy, and majestic is Thy glory, O Thou Who so loved Thy world that Thou gavest Thine Only-begotten Son, that whosoever believeth in Him should not perish, but have everlasting life; Who when He had come and fulfilled all the dispensation for us, on the night in which He was betrayed, or rather gave Himself up for the life of the world, took bread in His holy and most pure and unblemished hands, and when He had given thanks, and had blessed it, and hallowed it, and broken it, He gave it to His holy disciples and apostles, saying:

Exclamation:

If it be the Liturgy of St. John Chrysostom:

--Take, eat: this is My Body, which is broken for you for the remission of sins.

Choir: Amen.

--Drink of it, all of you: this is My Blood of the New Testament, which is shed for you and for many, for the remission of sins.

Choir: Amen.

But if it be the Liturgy of St. Basil the Great:

--He gave it to His holy disciples and apostles, saying: Take, eat: this is My Body, which is broken for you for the remission of sins.

Choir: Amen.

--He gave it to His holy disciples and apostles, saying: Drink of it, all of you: this is My Blood of the New Testament, which is shed for you and for many, for the remission of sins.

Choir: Amen.

Priest: Mindful, therefore, of this saving commandment and all those things which came to pass for us: the cross, the grave, the resurrection on the third day, the ascension into the heavens, the session at the right hand, the second and glorious coming again:

Priest: Thine own of Thine own we offer unto Thee, in behalf of all, and for all

Choir: We praise Thee, we bless Thee, we give thanks unto Thee, O Lord; and we pray unto Thee, O our God.

All make a prostration, if it be a weekday, but not if

And the priest prayeth:

Priest: Again we offer unto Thee this rational and bloodless service,
and we ask of Thee, and we pray Thee, and we entreat Thee: Send
down Thy Holy Spirit upon us and upon these Gifts set forth.

And the Priest and the deacon bow together thrice as the priest saith:

Priest: O God cleanse me a sinner and have mercy on me *Thrice*

And the Priest prayeth with raised hands, and the deacon respondeth, and each boweth thrice:

Priest: O Lord, Who didst send down Thy most Holy Spirit at the third
hour upon Thine apostles: Take Him not from us, O Good One, but
renew Him in us who pray unto Thee.

Stichos: Create in me a clean heart, O God, and renew a right spirit
within me. *Bow*

Priest: O Lord, Who didst send down Thy most Holy Spirit at the tz
hour upon Thine apostles: Take Him not from us, O Good One, but
renew Him in us who pray unto Thee.

Stichos: Cast me not away from Thy presence, and take not Thy Holy
Spirit from me. *Bow*

Priest: O Lord, Who didst send down Thy most Holy Spirit at the third
hour upon Thine apostles: Take Him not from us, O Good One, but
renew Him in us who pray unto Thee. *Bow*

Then bowing his head and pointing with his orarion to the Holy Bread, the deacon saith secretly:

Deacon only: Bless, Master, the Holy Bread.

And the priest, rising, maketh the sign of the cross over the Holy Gifts thrice, saying:

Priest: And make this Bread the precious Body of thy Christ;

Deacon: Amen.

And again the deacon pointeth to the holy chalice and saith:

Deacon only: Bless, Master, the Holy Cup.

And the priest blessing, saith:

Priest: And that which is in this Cup, the precious Blood of thy Christ:

Deacon: Amen.

And again the deacon, pointing to both the Holy Things saith:

Deacon only: Bless them both, Master.

And the priest, blessing both the Holy Things saith:

Priest: Changing them by thy Holy Spirit.

Deacon: Amen, Amen, Amen.

And the deacon, bowing his head to the priest saith:

Deacon only: Remember me a sinner, holy master.

And the priest saith:

Priest: May the Lord God remember thee in His Kingdom always, now
and ever and unto ages of ages.

Deacon only: Amen.

And the priest prayeth:

Priest: That to them that shall partake thereof, they may be unto sobriety of soul, unto the remission of sins, and unto the communion of Thy Holy Spirit, unto the fullness of the kingdom of heaven, unto boldness toward Thee; not unto judgment or condemnation. Again we offer unto Thee this rational service for them that in faith have gone to their rest before us: the forefathers, fathers, patriarchs, prophets, apostles, preachers, evangelists, martyrs, confessors, ascetics, and for every righteous spirit in faith made perfect.

And taking the censer, the priest censeth thrice before the Holy Table and exclaimeth:

And the priest prayeth:

Priest: That to them that shall partake thereof, they may be unto sobriety of soul, unto the remission of sins, and unto the communion of Thy Holy Spirit, unto the fullness of the kingdom of heaven, unto boldness toward Thee; not unto judgment or condemnation.

Again we offer unto Thee this rational service for them that in faith have gone to their rest before us: the forefathers, fathers, patriarchs, prophets, apostles, preachers, evangelists, martyrs, confessors, ascetics, and for every righteous spirit in faith made perfect.

And taking the censer, the priest censeth thrice before the Holy Table and exclaimeth:

Priest: Especially for our most holy, most pure, most blessed, glorious Lady Theotokos and Ever-Virgin Mary.

If it be the Liturgy of St. John Chrysostom:

Choir: It is truly meet to bless thee, the Theotokos, ever-blessed and most blameless, and Mother of our God. More honorable than the Cherubim, and beyond compare more glorious than the Seraphim, thee who without corruption gavest birth to God the Word, the very Theotokos, thee do we magnify.

Or the Zadostoinik of the Feast

But if it be the Liturgy of St. Basil the Great:

Choir: In thee rejoiceth, O thou who art full of grace, all creation, the angelic assembly, and the race of man; O sanctified temple and noetical paradise, praise of virgins, of whom God was incarnate, and became a child, He that was before the ages, even our God; for, of thy body a throne He made, and thy womb He made more spacious than the heavens. In thee rejoiceth, O thou who art full of grace, all creation: glory to thee.

Or, on the great feasts, the appointed megalynarion.

*All make a prostration, if it be a weekday, but not if
it be Great Feast of the Lord or the Theotokos.*

And the priest prayeth:

Priest: For the holy Prophet, Forerunner, and Baptist John; the holy and all-praised apostles; of Saint(s) N. (N.) whose memory we also celebrate; and for all Thy saints: through whose intercessions do Thou visit us, O God; and remember all that have departed in the hope of the resurrection unto life everlasting, and grant them rest where the light of Thy countenance shall visit them. →

Then the deacon censeth the Holy Table round about, and remembereth whomsoever he will, both of the living and of the dead.

Priest: Again we pray Thee; Remember, O Lord, all the Orthodox episcopate that rightly divide the word of Thy truth, all the priesthood, the diaconate in Christ, and every sacred rank. Again we offer unto Thee this rational service for the whole world; for the Holy, Catholic, and Apostolic Church; for them that abide in purity and an honorable life; for the much suffering Orthodox Russian people; for this land, its rulers and armed forces. Grant them, O Lord, peaceful governance, that in their calm we, also, may lead a quiet and peaceable life in all godliness and honesty.

And after the singing of the megalynarion ("It is truly meet"), the priest exclaimeth:

Priest: Among the first, remember, O Lord, our Great Lord and Father, His Holiness, Patriarch N.; and our lord the Very Most Reverend Metropolitan N., First Hierarch of the Russian Church Abroad; and our lord the Most Reverend (Archbishop or Bishop N.), whom do Thou grant unto Thy holy churches, in peace, safety, honor, health, and length of days, rightly dividing the word of Thy truth.

Choir: And each and every one.

And the priest prayeth:

Priest: Remember, O Lord, this city (*or town, or monastery*) wherein we dwell, and every city and country and the faithful that dwell therein. Remember, O Lord, them that travel by sea, land, and air; the sick, the suffering, the imprisoned, and their salvation. Remember, O Lord, them that bear fruit and do good works in Thy holy churches, and them that are mindful of the poor, and upon us all send down thy mercy.

Priest or Bishop: And grant us with one mouth, and one heart, to glorify and hymn Thy most honorable and majestic name: of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.

Choir: Amen.

Priest or Bishop: And may the mercies of our great God and Savior Jesus Christ be with you all.

Choir: And with thy spirit.

Deacon or Priest: Having called to remembrance all the saints, again and again, in peace let us pray to the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--For the precious Gifts offered and sanctified, let us pray to the Lord

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--That our God, the Lover of mankind, having accepted them upon His holy and most heavenly and noetic altar as an odor of spiritual fragrance, will send down upon us divine grace and the gift of the Holy Spirit, let us pray.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--That we may be delivered from all tribulation, wrath, and necessity, let us pray to the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy. (*Slowly, if there be no deacon.*)

--Help us, save us, have mercy on us, and keep us, O God, by Thy grace.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--That the whole day may be perfect, holy, peaceful and sinless, let us ask of the Lord.

Choir: Grant this, O Lord.

--An angel of peace, a faithful guide, a guardian of our souls and bodies, let us ask of the Lord.

Choir: Grant this, O Lord.

--Pardon and remission of our sins and offences, let us ask of the Lord.

Choir: Grant this, O Lord.

--Things good and profitable for souls, and peace for the world, let us ask of the Lord.

Choir: Grant this, O Lord.

--That we may complete the remaining time of our life in peace and repentance, let us ask of the Lord.

Choir: Grant this, O Lord.

--A Christian ending to our life, painless, blameless, peaceful, and a good defense before the dread judgment seat of Christ, let us ask.

Choir: Grant this, O Lord.

--Having asked for the unity of the faith and the communion of the Holy Spirit, let us commit ourselves and one another and all our life unto Christ our God.

Choir: To Thee, O Lord.

The priest prayeth:

The Prayer before the Lord's prayer

Priest: Unto thee we offer our whole life and hope O Master, Lover of mankind, and we ask Thee, and pray Thee, and supplicate Thee, vouchsafe us to partake of Thy heavenly and dread Mysteries of this holy and spiritual Table, with a pure conscience, unto remission of sins, unto pardon of offenses, unto communion of thy Holy Spirit, unto inheritance of the kingdom of heaven, unto boldness towards Thee; not unto judgment, nor unto condemnation.

Priest or Bishop: And vouchsafe us, O Master, with boldness and without condemnation to dare to call upon Thee the heavenly God as Father, and to say:

*All make a prostration, if it be a weekday, but not if
it be Great Feast of the Lord or the Theotokos.*

Choir: Our Father, who art in the Heavens, /hallowed be Thy name, Thy Kingdom come, // Thy will be done on earth as it is in heaven, / Give us this day our daily bread, // and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors; / and lead us not into temptation, // but deliver us from the evil one.

Priest or Bishop: For Thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory: of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.

Choir: Amen.

Priest: Peace be unto all.

Choir: And to thy spirit.

Deacon or Priest: Let us bow our heads unto the Lord.

Choir: To Thee, O Lord. *(Slowly.)*

And the priest prayeth:

The Prayer at the bowing of the heads

Priest: We give thanks unto Thee, O King invisible, who by Thine immeasurable might hast created all things, and in the multitude of Thy mercies hast brought all things from non-being into being; do Thou Thyself, O Master, look from heaven upon them that have bowed their heads unto Thee, for thy have not bowed down unto flesh and blood, but unto Thee, the awesome God. Do Thou therefore, O Master, distribute these Things here set forth unto us all for good, according to the need of each; sail with them that voyage, travel with them that journey, heal the sick, O Thou Physician of our souls and bodies.

Priest or Bishop: Through the grace and compassions and love for mankind of Thine Only-begotten Son, with Whom Thou art blessed, together with Thy most holy, and good, and life-creating Spirit, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.

Choir: Amen. *(Slowly.)*

Deacon or Priest: Let us attend!

Priest or Bishop: Holy Things are for the holy.

Choir: One is Holy, One is Lord, Jesus Christ, to the glory of God the Father. Amen.

And the communion hymn.

The communion verse for most Sundays is: Praise the Lord from the heavens, praise Him in the highest. Alleluia, alleluia, alleluia.

On Monday: Who maketh His angels spirits, and His ministers a flame of fire *(Ps 103)*

On Tuesday: In everlasting remembrance shall the righteous be, he shall not be afraid of evil tidings *(Ps 91:12)*

On Wednesday: I will take the cup of salvation, and I will call upon the name of the Lord *(Ps 44:11)*

On Thursday: Their sound hath gone forth into all the world, and their words unto the ends of the world. Alleluia, alleluia, alleluia. *(Ps 18:4)*

On Friday: Thou hast wrought salvation in the midst of the earth, O God *(Ps 73)*

On Saturday: Rejoice in the Lord, O ye righteous; praise is meet for the upright

During the communion of the clergy, selected hymns may be chanted, or the Prayers before Holy Communion may be read.

Then:

Deacon or Priest: With fear of God and with faith, draw nigh.

Choir: Blessed is He that cometh in the name of the Lord. God is the Lord, and hath appeared unto us.

Priest or Bishop: I believe, O Lord, and I confess that Thou art truly the Christ, the Son of the living God, Who didst come into the world to save sinners, of whom I am chief. Moreover, I believe that this is truly Thy most pure Body, and that this is truly Thine Own Precious Blood. Wherefore, I pray Thee: Have mercy on me and forgive me my transgressions, voluntary and involuntary, in word and in deed, in knowledge and in ignorance. And vouchsafe me to partake without condemnation of Thy most pure Mysteries unto the remission of sins and life everlasting.

Of Thy Mystical Supper, O Son of God, receive me today as a communicant; for I will not speak of the Mystery to Thine enemies, nor will I give Thee a kiss as did Judas, but like the Thief do I confess Thee: Remember me, O Lord, in Thy kingdom.

Let not the communion of Thy Holy Mysteries be unto me for judgment or condemnation, O Lord, but for healing of soul and body.

And as each person receiveth Holy Communion, the priest or bishop saith:

The servant (or handmaid) of God, N., partaketh of the precious and holy Body and Blood of our Lord and God and Savior Jesus Christ unto the remission of sins and life everlasting.

Choir: Receive ye the Body of Christ; taste ye of the Fountain of Immortality. Alleluia, alleluia, alleluia.

After all have communed:

Priest or Bishop: Save O God, Thy people and bless Thine inheritance.

Choir: We have seen the True Light; we have received the Heavenly Spirit. We have found the True Faith. We worship the Indivisible Trinity: for He hath saved us.

Priest or Bishop: Always, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.

Choir: Amen. Let our mouth be filled with Thy praise, O Lord, that we may hymn Thy glory, for Thou hast vouchsafed us to partake of Thy holy, divine, immortal and life-creating Mysteries. Keep us in Thy holiness, that we may meditate on Thy righteousness all the day long. Alleluia, alleluia, alleluia.

Deacon or Priest: Aright! Having partaken of the divine, holy, most pure, immortal, heavenly, and life-creating, fearful Mysteries of Christ, let us worthily give thanks unto the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--Help us, save us, have mercy on us, and keep us, O God, by Thy grace.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

--Having asked that the whole day may be perfect, holy, peaceful and sinless, let us commit ourselves and one another and all our life unto Christ our God.

Choir: To Thee, O Lord.

Priest or Bishop: For Thou art our sanctification, and unto Thee do we send up glory: to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.

Choir: Amen.

-- Let us depart in peace.

Choir: In the name of the Lord.

Deacon or Priest: Let us pray to the Lord.

Choir: Lord, have mercy.

The Prayer Behind the Ambo:

Priest: O Lord Who dost bless them that bless Thee and sanctify them that put their trust in Thee: Save Thy people and bless Thine inheritance; preserve the fullness of Thy Church, sanctify them that love the beauty of Thy house; do Thou glorify them by Thy divine power, and forsake us not that hope in Thee. Give peace to Thy world, to Thy churches, to the priests, and to all Thy people. For every good gift and every perfect gift is from above, and cometh down from Thee, the Father of lights, and unto Thee do we send up glory and thanksgiving and worship, to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.

Choir: Amen. Blessed be the name of the Lord from henceforth and forever more.
Thrice.

Psalm 33

I will bless the Lord at all times, * His praise shall continually be in my mouth.
*In the Lord shall my soul be praised; * let the meek hear and be glad.

O magnify the Lord with me, * and let us exalt His name together. * I sought the Lord, and He heard me, * and delivered me from all my tribulations.

Come unto Him, and be enlightened, * and your faces shall not be ashamed. *
This poor man cried, and the Lord heard him, * and saved him out of all his tribulations.

The angel of the Lord will encamp round about them that fear Him, * and will deliver them. * O taste and see that the Lord is good; * blessed is the man that hopeth in Him.

O fear the Lord, all ye His saints; * for there is no want to them that fear Him. *
Rich men have turned poor and gone hungry; * but they that seek the Lord shall not be deprived of any good thing.

Come ye children, hearken unto me; * I will teach you the fear of the Lord. *
What man is there that desireth life, * who loveth to see good days?

Keep thy tongue from evil, * and thy lips from speaking guile. * Turn away from evil, and do good; * seek peace, and pursue it.

The eyes of the Lord are upon the righteous, * and His ears are opened unto their supplication. * The face of the Lord is against them that do evil, * utterly to destroy the remembrance of them from the earth.

The righteous cried, and the Lord heard them, * and He delivered them out of all their tribulations. * The Lord is nigh unto them that are of a contrite heart, * and He will save the humble of spirit. *

Many are the tribulations of the righteous, * and the Lord shall deliver them out of them all. * The Lord keepeth all their bones, * not one of them shall be broken.

The death of sinners is evil, * and they that hate the righteous shall do wrong. *
The Lord will redeem the souls of His servants, * and none of them will do wrong that hope in Him.

Priest or Bishop: The blessing of the Lord be upon you, through His grace and love for mankind, always, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.

Choir: Amen.

--Glory to Thee, O Christ God, our hope, glory to Thee.

Choir: Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, both now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. Amen.

Lord, have mercy. Thrice. Father (master) bless.

Priest or Bishop: May Christ our true God, (on Sundays: Who rose from the dead), through the intercessions of His most pure Mother; of the holy and glorious apostles; of our father (or Basil the Great, archbishop of Caesarea in Cappadocia); and Saint(s) N.(N.) (to whom the church is dedicated); and Saint(s) N.(N) (of the day); of the holy and righteous ancestors of God, Joachim and Anna; and of all the saints: have mercy on us and save us, for He is good and loveth mankind.

Choir: Amen.

The Many years

Our Great Lord and Father Kyrill, /
the Most-holy Patriarch of Moscow and All Russia; /
our Lord the Very Most Reverend Metropolitan Hilarion; /
First Hierarch of the Russian Church Abroad, /
and our Lord the Most Reverend Archbishop Peter; /
the brotherhood of this holy temple, /
and all Orthodox Christians: //
preserve, O Lord, for many years.

The End of the Divine Liturgy

¹ All Great Mysteries are introduced with this beginning Blessing. For example: Baptism. This exclamation is not used to introduce any of the other regular services, such as Vespers, Matins, the Hours, etc. It reflects our theology, the firm knowledge that when we celebrate the Divine Liturgy, we enter into the Kingdom of God.

² We ask for “peace” several times in the liturgy. Remember that the first words Jesus spoke to the assembled apostles after His resurrection were about peace. Christianity can be called, among many other things, the pursuit of peace. This peace is not as the world understands peace, but it is the calmness and purity of a perfected heart, when God abides.

“Then the same day at evening, being the first day of the week, when the doors were shut where the disciples were assembled for fear of the Jews, came Jesus and stood in the midst, and saith unto them, Peace be unto you. (20) And when he had so said, he shewed unto them his hands and his side. Then were the disciples glad, when they saw the Lord. (21) Then said Jesus to them again, Peace be unto you: as my Father hath sent me, even so send I you.”(John 20:19-21 KJV)

³ This petition, and the one following are uniquely used in the Russian Orthodox Church. These petitions were inserted when the Russian Orthodox Church languished under communism. After she became free again, the petitions were edited somewhat. The original versions history is:

“For the much suffering Russian Land and its Orthodox people both in the homeland and in the diaspora, and for their salvation, let us pray to the Lord. “

Which became:

“For the God preserved Russian Land and its Orthodox people both in the homeland and in the diaspora, and for their salvation, let us pray to the Lord. “

“That He may deliver His people from the godless civil authority, and confirm in us oneness of mind, brotherly love and piety, let us pray to the Lord. “

Which became:

“That He may deliver His people from enemies both visible and invisible, and confirm in us oneness of mind, brotherly love and piety, let us pray to the Lord. “